Raising Talents

BRAND STYLE GUIDE · VERSION 1.0

YOUR TALENT, IN THE *spotlight.*

How Raising Talents looks, sounds and behaves: logo, colour, type, voice, imagery and the rules that keep them working together across the website and the app.

October 2026 · Prepared for the Raising Talents team

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01 · THE IDEA

THE STAGE AND *the spotlight.*

Every talent has a moment when the lights come up: the first trial, the first audition, the first open mic. Raising Talents is that moment, made available to anyone with a phone.

The stage

A deep, warm near-black. It is where the work is shown: the hero of the website, a talent's profile cover, the showcase of a reel. It stays dark in both light and dark mode, because it is a moment, not a surface.

The spotlight

A warm marigold. It is the light on the talent and the one thing on a screen you should press. It is also the colour of a Lagos sunrise, which is where "raising" comes from.

Around them sits warm paper for everyday reading, one spark of energy (ember) for likes and live moments, and one colour of trust (verified teal) that appears only on things a person has checked.

This guide replaces the colours and type picked during early development (a violet button colour, a violet to pink to orange gradient, Figtree and Bricolage Grotesque). That look has become the default for AI-built products and says nothing about this one.

02 · AUDIENCE AND PERSONALITY

WHO WE *speak to.*

Raising Talents is a home where athletes, musicians, models, actors, dancers, artists and creators post their best work, grow a following, and get found by verified agents and scouts. Open in 244 countries and territories, built in Lagos.

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY WANT	WHAT THEY NEED TO HEAR
Talent 18 and over, anywhere	To be seen by someone who can change their career	It is free, it is safe, your work does the talking
Agents and scouts	To find real talent fast, without noise	Every profile is a real person, search by skill and place, verified agencies only
Parents, coaches, managers	To know the platform is safe and serious	Verified agents, moderated photos, report and block on every profile

Raising Talents is warm, bold and honest.

Warm

Not cute. We cheer for people. We never talk down to them.

Bold

Not loud. Big type, strong photography, one bright colour used with discipline.

Honest

Not hype. No promises of fame. We say what happens: you post, people follow, agents get in touch.

03 · VOICE AND WRITING

TALK LIKE *a good coach.*

Short sentences, plain words, second person. Encouraging, specific, never overpromising.

DO	DON'T
Post your work. Get seen.	Unlock your limitless creative potential
Agents in 40 countries searched for dancers this week.	Thousands of opportunities await!
Your photo is with a moderator.	Oops! Something went wrong
Join as talent	Get started now for free!!!
Get seen by verified scouts.	Get signed and become famous

Rules

- Sentence case for buttons and titles. Uppercase only for display headlines and labels.
- Name real places and real disciplines ("a dancer in Nairobi"), never "users" or "creatives".
- No exclamation marks in the product. One is allowed on a celebration screen.
- Numbers as figures: 3 new followers, 1,204 likes.
- No emoji in the interface. People can use them in their own posts.
- Never promise an outcome ("get signed"). Promise the next step ("get seen").
- Error messages say what happened and how to fix it, in one or two sentences.

TAGLINES

YOUR TALENT DESERVES *a stage.*
YOUR TALENT, IN THE *spotlight.*
THE NEXT ONE TO RISE COULD BE *you.*

04 · LOGO

A FIGURE, *arms raised.*

A person with arms raised under a spotlight: a marigold head and V on the stage. The small ember dot is the spark that comes with being noticed.



rt-mark

Default. App icon, favicon, official avatar.



rt-mark-spotlight

On the stage and dark photography.



rt-figure-ink

One colour: stamps, embroidery, watermarks.

Lockups





Wordmark

"Raising Talents" set in Archivo Narrow 700, sentence case, letter spacing -0.01em. The mark sits at 1.4 times the cap height. Until a designer draws a custom wordmark, always set it in the font, never in a fallback.

Clear space

Keep clear space equal to the head's diameter on every side. Minimum size: 24px on screen, 8mm in print.

Never

- Recolour the mark outside the versions shown here.
- Add a gradient, shadow or outline.
- Rotate, stretch or crop it.
- Place the ink version on the stage.
- Set the wordmark in another typeface.

05 · COLOUR

THE WORK CARRIES *the colour.*

The interface stays warm and quiet, and gives each bright colour one job.

Spotlight
#FFB627 · The primary action and the brand. One per screen.

Stage
#16130F

Canvas
#F7F2EA

Ember
#E8492B

Verified
#0F6E63

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	JOB
spotlight	#FFB627	#FFB627	Primary action fill, the logo
spotlight-ink	#16130F	#16130F	Text on spotlight (10.6:1)
spotlight-text	#9A6A00	#FFB627	Marigold used as text or a thin icon
spotlight-soft	#FFF1D1	#3A2E14	Selected chip, new notification row
stage	#16130F	#0E0C09	Heroes, profile covers, showcases
canvas	#F7F2EA	#16130F	Page background
surface	#FFFFFF	#211D18	Cards, posts, inputs
ink / ink-muted	#16130F / #5E574D	#F7F2EA / #B5AC9E	Text and secondary text
line / line-strong	#E4DCCF / #8A8072	#36302A / #8F8576	Hairlines / control outlines
ember / ember-text	#E8492B / #C2361B	#FF7A5C	Likes, live, unread. Energy, never alarm
verified	#0F6E63	#4FC2B2	Verified agents, success. Earned only
danger	#B3261E	#FF8F87	Errors and destructive actions

RULES THAT KEEP *it working.*

1

Spotlight is one per screen

If two things are marigold, neither is the action. A second action is an outline button in ink.

2

Ink on marigold, always

White on marigold fails contrast. Text on spotlight is always spotlight-ink.

3

Gold text is darker gold

Marigold used as text uses spotlight-text (#9A6A00), which passes on white.

4

Ember is not an error

It means energy: a like, a live dot. Errors use danger.

5

Verified is earned

The teal tick never decorates. It means a moderator checked this agency.

6

No gradients in the interface

The one exception: a soft radial spotlight of marigold at 25 to 40% behind hero media on the stage.

Contrast checks (WCAG AA)

Aa Ink on spotlight · 10.6:1	**Aa** Ink on canvas · 16.6:1	**Aa** Muted on white · 7.1:1	**Aa** Muted on stage · 8.3:1
Aa Gold text on white · 4.7:1	**Aa** Ember text on white · 5.5:1	**Aa** Verified on soft · 5.3:1	**Aa** Verified, dark · 7.7:1

Every text pairing in the system passes WCAG AA (4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for control outlines and large text) in both light and dark themes. Dark mode follows the phone's setting.

06 · TYPOGRAPHY

POSTER TYPE WITH *a human note.*

Three families, all free on Google Fonts.

DISPLAY · ARCHIVO NARROW 700

96 / 64 / 40 px · uppercase on marketing

RAISE YOUR TALENT

Headlines that feel like a festival poster or a team sheet. Sentence case for names and app titles.

ACCENT · INSTRUMENT SERIF ITALIC

matches the headline size

the world

One to three words inside a headline. Never a whole line, never in the app's working screens. Also for pull quotes.

TEXT · ARCHIVO 400 TO 700

everything else

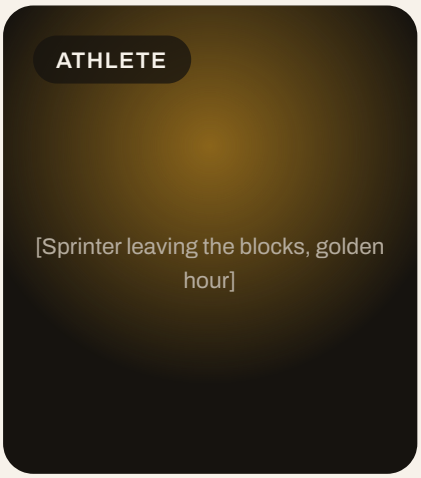
Get discovered

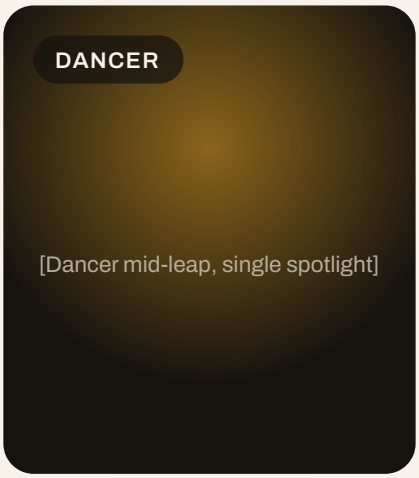
Post your work, grow a following and get found by agents.

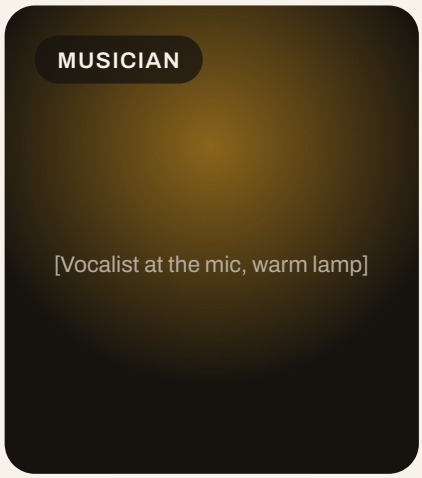
STYLE	FAMILY	SIZE / LINE	USE
display-xl	Archivo Narrow 700	96 / 0.92	Homepage hero only (56px on phones)
display-l	Archivo Narrow 700	64 / 0.95	Marketing section headlines (40px on phones)
display-m	Archivo Narrow 700	40 / 1.0	Talent name on profile, app page titles
title	Archivo 700	22 / 1.25	Card and sheet titles
body-l	Archivo 400	18 / 1.55	Lead paragraphs
body	Archivo 400	16 / 1.5	Default text. Never below 16px in inputs
label	Archivo 600, +0.06em	13 / 1.3	Eyebrows, tags, tabs. Uppercase
caption	Archivo 400	13 / 1.4	Timestamps, counts, helper text

REAL PEOPLE, *mid-performance.*

Photography is the brand's main colour. Treat it with care.







- **Real people mid-performance.** A sprinter out of the blocks, a singer between lines, a dancer at full extension. Never posed stock smiles at laptops.
- **Warm, directional light.** Stage light, golden hour, a single lamp. Shadows are welcome.
- **Africa first, the world always.** Lagos, Nairobi and Accra beside London, São Paulo and Seoul.
- **Consent first.** Only talent who agreed to be featured, all 18 or over. Until then, use the placeholder above: stage ground, radial spotlight, a caption naming the photo needed.
- **Crop tight and vertical.** 4:5 for posts and cards, 9:16 for reels.

Iconography

Lucide icons at a 1.75px stroke on 24px. Icons are paired with a label, except in the bottom tab bar and on universally known actions (like, share, more), which still get an accessible label.

DISCIPLINE	ICON	DISCIPLINE	ICON
Athletes	Medal	Dancers	Music
Musicians	Mic	Creators	Sparkles
Models	Camera	Artists	Palette
Actors	Clapperboard		

PILLS YOU PRESS, *cards you read.*

Radius

radius-sm	8px	Inputs, thumbnails, tags
radius-md	16px	Cards, posts, sheets
radius-lg	28px	Hero media, showcase tiles
radius-pill	999px	Buttons, chips, avatars



Spacing (8px rhythm)

space-1 / 2 / 3	4 / 8 / 12px	Inside chips and rows
space-4	16px	Phone gutter, card padding
space-6	24px	Desktop gutter, card gaps
space-8	32px	Between groups
space-12	48px	Sections in the app
space-24	96px	Marketing sections (64 on phones)

Depth

Borders, not shadows, for structure. The one shadow (shadow-lift) is for things that float: menus, toasts, the hero phone.

Motion

150ms for state changes, 250ms for sheets and pages, ease-out. A like pops once. Everything respects reduced motion settings.

Touch

Targets are 44px or larger. Buttons are 48px tall on phones. Inputs use 16px text so phones do not zoom.

Accessibility checklist

- AA contrast in both themes for every text and control pairing.
- A visible 2px focus ring with a 2px offset on every control: ink on light, spotlight on dark.
- Real buttons and links, labels above inputs, alt text on every portfolio image.
- Colours that must be told apart also differ in lightness, not hue alone.
- Error text says how to fix the problem.

BUILT FROM *the same parts.*

Buttons

Join as talent Join as agent Sign in Block

Watch the reel Message

Pills, 48px tall (36px small), Archivo 600. One primary per screen. Every other action is secondary (outline), quiet (text) or danger (red outline).

Chips and badges

Athletes Musicians Models Actors Dancers

✓ Verified agency New DANCER · LONDON

Talent card



Tobi Adebayo
Sprinter · Ibadan, Nigeria

2.4k followers Save

- 4:5 media on the stage with a discipline tag.
- Name in Archivo Narrow 700, discipline and city in ink-muted.
- Follower count and a Save action that adds the talent to a shortlist.
- Until consented photos exist, show the stage with a radial spotlight and a caption naming the photo needed.
- Used in search results, shortlists and on the homepage.

10 · MOVING FROM THE CURRENT BUILD

OLD TOKENS, *new names.*

The web app uses shadcn tokens in `apps/web/src/styles/app.css`. Map them like this.

CURRENT TOKEN	OLD VALUE	NEW TOKEN	NEW VALUE (LIGHT / DARK)
--primary	`#6d28d9`	**spotlight**	`#FFB627 / #FFB627`
--primary-foreground	`#ffffff`	**spotlight-ink**	`#16130F`
--background	`#ffffff`	**canvas**	`#F7F2EA / #16130F`
--card	`#ffffff`	**surface**	`#FFFFFF / #211D18`
--foreground	`#14111f`	**ink**	`#16130F / #F7F2EA`
--muted-foreground	`#5d5873`	**ink-muted**	`#5E574D / #B5AC9E`
--accent	`#ede8fd`	**spotlight-soft**	`#FFF1D1 / #3A2E14`
--stage	`#160f2e`	**stage**	`#16130F / #0E0C09`
--spotlight	`#ff9ec7`	**spotlight-soft**	`#FFF1D1 / #3A2E14`
--like	`#e11d48`	**ember**	`#E8492B / #FF7A5C`
--success	`#1e7a4c`	**verified**	`#0F6E63 / #4FC2B2`
--destructive	`#b3261e`	**danger**	`#B3261E / #FF8F87`
--border	`#e6e2ef`	**line**	`#E4DCCF / #36302A`
--input	`#8983a0`	**line-strong**	`#8A8072 / #8F8576`
--ring	`#7c3aed`	**focus**	`#16130F / #FFB627`
--brand-from/via/to	gradient	**removed**	Use spotlight solid, or the logo
--font-sans	Figtree	**Archivo**	@fontsource/archivo
--font-display	Bricolage Grotesque	**Archivo Narrow 700**	Plus Instrument Serif italic for accents

Self-host the fonts with `@fontsource/archivo`, `@fontsource/archivo-narrow` and `@fontsource/instrument-serif` so the installed app works offline.



THE NEXT ONE TO RISE COULD BE *you.*

Raising Talents · Made in Lagos for talent everywhere